

Daily Market Summary

August 18, 2026

Market Tone — Today's Session

A recap of how the market traded today — not a forecast.

Today: **-0.35 → Bearish**

Trend (5-day EMA): **-0.10 → Neutral** — smoothed, the readable day-over-day signal.

Component	Weight	Score
Market data	70%	-0.35
News headlines	20%	-0.49
Fed (rate expectations)	10%	-0.01

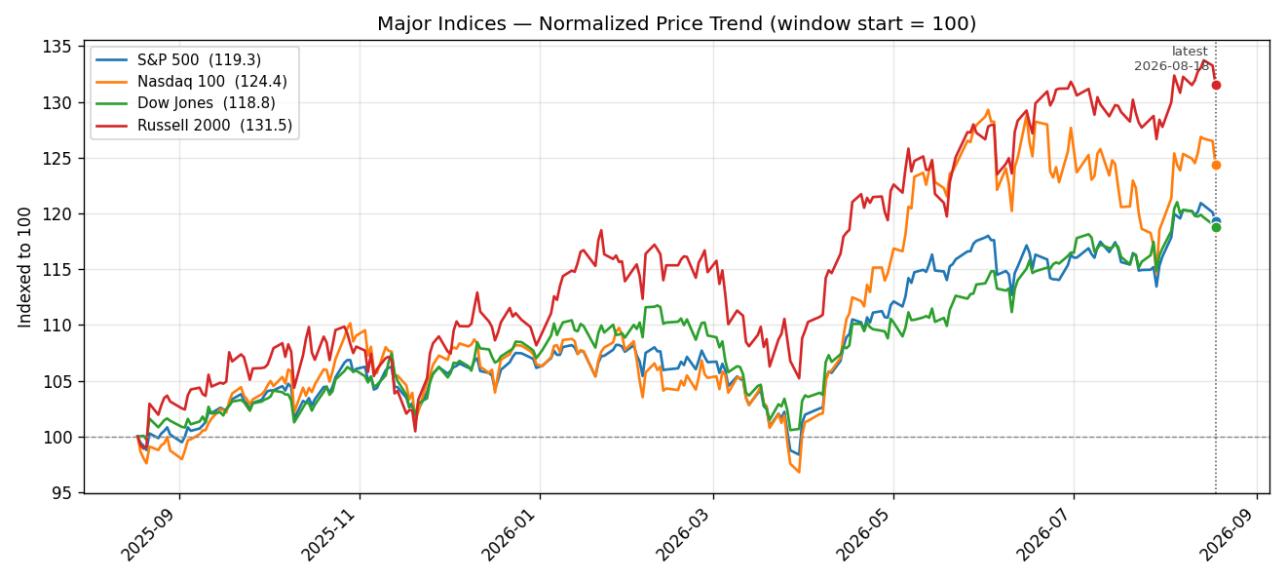
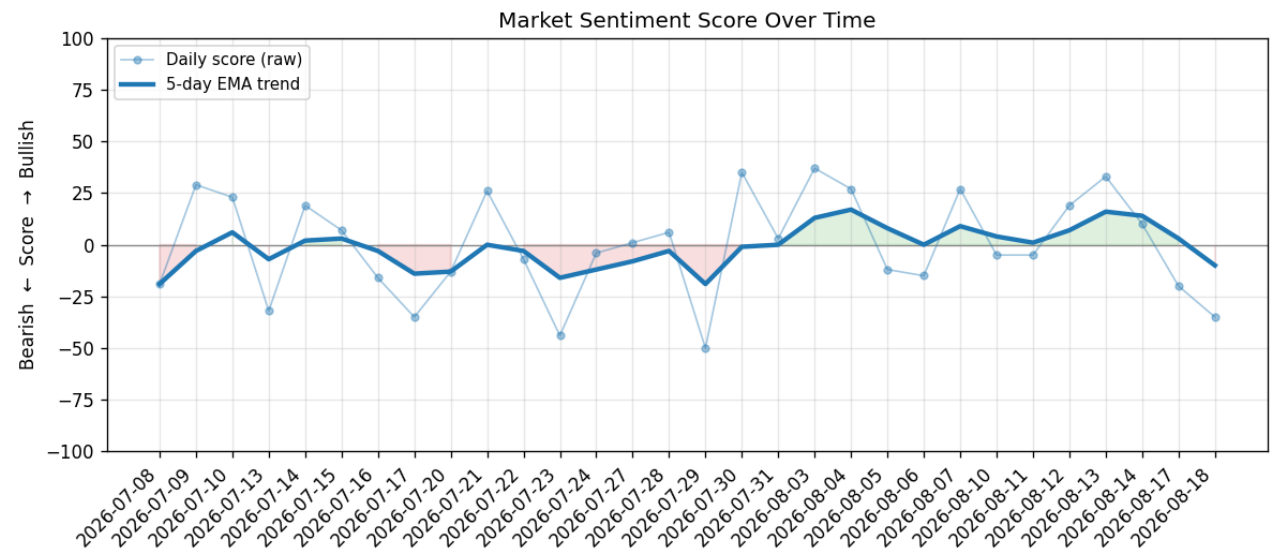
Equities fell with Nasdaq -1.7%, S&P 500 -0.7%, VIX +4.3%. Sector breadth: 4/11 sectors up. 10Y yield -0.4%. News headlines read bearish. Fed-policy expectations held steady. Today's overall market tone: Bearish. (news scored with finbert)

Standout headlines

Most bullish (+0.17) — Meta is facing its 'Big Tobacco' moment — and investors can profit

Most bearish (-0.93) — Analysis: Bond market pressure is squeezing Main Street as Wall Street waits on Warsh

Trend Charts



Sector Watch (AI Stack)

Score describes the day: driven by the session move (70%), with breadth (avg % of the 20/50-day MAs the basket trades above, 15%) and news (15%) for texture. Relative strength (vs the Nasdaq for tech baskets, the S&P for the rest) is shown as a context column but doesn't drive the label. Sorted strongest→weakest.

Sector	Move	Rel. Str.	Breadth	News	Overall
Pharma / Healthcare	+1.81%	+2.50% vs S&P	88%	Neutral	Bullish (+0.74)
Consumer	+0.66%	+1.35% vs S&P	56%	Neutral	Bullish (+0.35)
Banking	-0.14%	+0.55% vs S&P	88%	Neutral	Slightly Bullish (+0.18)
SaaS	-0.53%	+1.15% vs Nasdaq	89%	Neutral	Neutral (-0.07)
Hyperscalers & Neoclouds	-2.63%	-0.95% vs Nasdaq	64%	Slightly Bearish	Bearish (-0.79)
Memory (DRAM/NAND/HBM)	-8.22%	-6.54% vs Nasdaq	50%	Neutral	Bearish (-0.79)
Semiconductors / Compute	-4.17%	-2.49% vs Nasdaq	40%	Slightly Bearish	Bearish (-0.83)
Networking / Interconnect	-7.82%	-6.14% vs Nasdaq	43%	Bearish	Bearish (-0.85)

Positioning & Regime

Was today bullish or bearish, read through positioning: out-of-the-money put/call volume (hedging vs chasing, daily) and short %-of-float (squeeze fuel; exchange data, biweekly) explain the character of the day's move — squeeze rebound, hedged advance, conviction selling. **Under evaluation** — logged daily, drives no scores.

Basket	OTM P/C	Short Flt	Day	Today's Read
Banking	2.04	0.0%	-0.14%	Neutral — flat session, but protection heavily bid underneath
Pharma / Healthcare	1.01	1.7%	+1.81%	Bullish — broad advance; positioning unremarkable
Consumer	0.84	2.1%	+0.66%	Bullish — broad advance; positioning unremarkable
SaaS	0.70	4.0%	-0.53%	Bearish — orderly decline; positioning unremarkable
Memory (DRAM/NAND/HBM)	0.68	5.7%	-8.22%	Bearish — decline without hedging demand — flows not panicked
Semiconductors / Compute	0.51	2.4%	-4.17%	Bearish — decline without hedging demand — flows not panicked

Networking / Interconnect	0.50	4.1%	-7.82%	Bearish — decline without hedging demand — flows not panicked
Hyperscalers & Neoclouds	0.45	1.4%	-2.63%	Bearish — decline without hedging demand — flows not panicked
All tracked	0.58	2.5%	-0.60%	Bearish — decline without hedging demand — flows not panicked

Top Gainers

Company	Price	% Change
Amylyx Pharmaceuticals, Inc. (AMLX)	35.11	+63.84%
Haemonetics Corporation (HAE)	104.65	+15.93%
UGI Corporation (UGI)	38.39	+9.40%
Heartflow, Inc. (HTFL)	45.23	+7.84%
BRP Inc. (DOO)	68.58	+7.50%

Top News

Gold prices today, Tuesday, August 18, 2026: Gold falters as U.S. Treasury yields rise — Yahoo Finance

Meta is facing its ‘Big Tobacco’ moment — and investors can profit — MarketWatch (Top)

Even a loss in the landmark youth-safety trial would do little to hurt Mark Zuckerberg's empire.

What Chinese liquor maker Moutai's slump says about the country's economy — CNBC (Finance)

Kweichow Moutai's half-year report showed a rare drop in net profit, following the first annual drop on record.

Meta rejects claims it sought to hook children to Facebook, Instagram as landmark trial begins — Investing.com

Silver prices today, Tuesday, August 18, 2026: Silver price holds as investors weigh inflation and geopolitical risks — Yahoo Finance

Market Snapshot

Major Indices

Instrument	Price	Change	% Change
S&P 500	7,691.76	-53.30	-0.69%
Nasdaq 100	29,490.96	-504.42	-1.68%
Dow Jones	53,343.40	-116.38	-0.22%
Russell 2000	3,017.89	-39.65	-1.30%
VIX	15.84	+0.65	+4.28%

Key Stocks

Instrument	Price	Change	% Change
Nvidia	219.74	-5.27	-2.34%
Microsoft	481.63	+1.28	+0.27%
AMD	484.39	-21.61	-4.27%
Meta	543.67	-25.30	-4.45%
Alphabet	341.28	-0.17	-0.05%
Broadcom	380.00	-12.43	-3.17%
Micron	940.76	-70.99	-7.02%
Intel	96.69	-6.80	-6.58%
SanDisk	1,625.78	-161.07	-9.01%
Coherent	306.43	-44.79	-12.75%
Amazon	259.45	-1.86	-0.71%
Apple	310.03	+4.44	+1.45%
Arm	253.32	-18.11	-6.67%

Commodities & Crypto

Instrument	Price	Change	% Change
Gold	4,383.00	-37.60	-0.85%
Crude Oil	84.51	+0.45	+0.54%
Bitcoin	64,744.02	+266.76	+0.41%

FX Rates

Instrument	Price	Change	% Change
EUR/USD	1.16	+0.00	+0.01%
USD/JPY	159.59	+0.01	+0.01%
GBP/USD	1.35	+0.00	+0.01%

Interest Rates

Instrument	Price	Change	% Change
10Y Treasury Yield	4.71	-0.02	-0.38%
13-Week T-Bill Yield	3.71	+0.00	+0.05%